



Six Elements of Classical Education School Website Audit

School: Founders Classical Academy: Prosper
School Website: <https://wwwFOUNDERSPROSPER.COM/>

January 6, 2026

Artificial Intelligence Disclaimer

This audit was performed using artificial intelligence tools to evaluate the presence and strength of classical education principles on school websites. Results are automated, probabilistic in nature, and should be considered indicative rather than definitive. See the full disclaimer in the Appendix more details.

SCL MEMBER

Any school that belongs to the Society for Classical Learning (SCL) is, by definition, recognized as a classical school because SCL requires adherence to the six essential elements defined by the Humanitas Institute. However, a school's website may not clearly reflect its conformity to one or more elements. In such cases, the school may still receive a "Somewhat Classical" rating for those elements. Schools can update their website content at any time to achieve a "Classical" rating for a given element.

Overall Classification: CLASSICAL

Executive Summary

Founders Classical Academy – Prosper, TX presents a clearly articulated classical-education orientation, anchored in a traditional liberal-arts framework and a virtue- and character-formation ethos. Public-facing materials emphasize a formation-focused goal (virtue, wisdom, citizenship) and an orientation toward truth, beauty, and goodness within a classical liberal-arts curriculum. However, explicit, model statements around certain classical pedagogical practices (e.g., Socratic dialogue in the upper grades, Great Books curriculum, living faculty as the curricular core, and robust parent-co-teaching structures) are not uniformly spelled out in the site materials. The school appears to align most strongly with Classical education in its stated mission and goals, with more partial alignment in curriculum specifics, pedagogy details, and faculty/parent-community articulation. Overall classification: SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL.

- Evidence across sources shows a classical frame (classical education, liberal arts focus, virtue formation, truth/beauty/goodness) but with limited explicit reference to several hallmark elements (Great Books, explicit Socratic pedagogy, "living curriculum," and explicit parent-co-teaching language) in the public materials. The accreditation note (campus of ResponsiveEd; TEA recognition) confirms a formal public-school context rather than a religious or sectarian program. See supporting evidence below.
- EXECUTIVE SUMMARY — CATEGORY-BY-CATEGORY SNAPSHOT
- Element 1: Religious and Metaphysical Foundations — SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL
- Element 2: School Purpose and Goal — CLASSICAL
- Element 3: Curriculum — SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL
- Element 4: Pedagogy — SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL
- Element 5: Faculty — NOT CLASSICAL
- Element 6: Parents & Community — SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL
- What would move the needle: Concrete, public-facing additions that would push the school toward full CLASSICAL status include explicit articulation of Great Books/Great Conversation in the curriculum, clear statements about Socratic or seminar-style pedagogy in upper grades, a formal "living curriculum" portrait of the teacher as part of the curriculum, and explicit parent-education/co-teaching initiatives (e.g., parent book studies, regular parent visits, and structured parent participation in learning). See "What would move the needle" section for specifics.

Executive Summary — Element-by-Element Snapshot

Element 1: Religious and Metaphysical Foundations — SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL

Evidence - Public materials emphasize a formation-oriented frame grounded in virtues, truth, beauty, and goodness. The site speaks of “a distinctive classical education that pursues knowledge, promotes virtue, and prepares students for prosperous lives in a free society,” and notes an orientation toward truth, beauty, and goodness. This reflects transcendental moral realism, at least in stated aims and themes. - There is no explicit statement of theology, liturgical practice, or formal worship within the public content. While virtue and moral formation are foregrounded, theological grounding or liturgical practices are not described in the visible public materials.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords present (category-relevant): virtue, virtuous, truth, beauty, goodness, formation (of character), classical, liberal arts, education, citizens. These terms appear in FCA Prosper’s public content. - Negative keywords present: none evident in the public materials for this category (no explicit theology or liturgy terms; no explicit “anti-formation” signals).

Why this rating - The materials demonstrate a strong normative stance around virtue and transcendent aims (truth, beauty, goodness) but lack explicit theology and liturgical practices. With 1 of 3 core sub-criteria evidenced, this category lands as SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL rather than CLASSICAL.

Element 2: School Purpose and Goal — CLASSICAL

Evidence - The school explicitly states the goal of public education is to form responsible citizens and virtuous people who can flourish, placing formation and character at the center of education. - It emphasizes cultivation of virtue and wisdom; it references truth, goodness, and beauty as real and knowable within the education process. - The curriculum is described as a traditional liberal-arts framework, aligning with formation-oriented aims rather than purely instrumental outcomes.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords present: formation, virtue, virtuous, citizens, truth, goodness, beauty, liberal arts, education. - Negative keywords present: explicit job/career orientation is not foregrounded as a primary goal; the emphasis remains formation and virtuous life. This aligns with the formation narrative rather than a purely job-prep narrative.

Why this rating - The school foregrounds formation, virtue, wisdom, and the real-knowledge of truth/goodness/beauty, consistent with CLASSICAL goals as defined by the Six Essential Elements. The explicit formation-then-formation orientation and the emphasis on classical virtues place this category solidly in CLASSICAL territory.

Element 3: School Curriculum — SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL

Evidence - The materials describe a classical approach with a traditional liberal-arts and sciences curriculum. This aligns with core classical curriculum assumptions (grammar, logic, rhetoric as a framework in classical pedagogy) and a cross-disciplinary liberal-arts focus. - There is no explicit mention of Great Books, the Great Conversation, or a formal Great Books program on the public-facing site content. The explicit containment of history as a separate field or integration as “Great Books” is not stated. - The site does not explicitly reference the Trivium/Quadrivium, nor a deliberate Great Books/Great Conversation curriculum, though it stresses a classical, liberal-arts orientation. - The site hints at an emphasis on “wonder” and integrated learning via a classical frame, but explicit Great Books, history-as-history-not-social-studies, or universal canonical readings are not spelled out in public content.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords present: liberal arts, classical education, liberal arts and sciences, formation, truth/beauty/goodness, classical, education. - Negative keywords present: Great Books/Great Conversation (absent), explicit history-as-Western-canon framing (absent). The absence of these targeted elements constitutes a gap relative to a full classical-curriculum specification.

Why this rating - The curriculum is framed within a classical-liberal-arts model, but key hallmark elements (explicit Great Books/Great Conversation, Trivium/Quadrivium, explicit history-as-canon work) are not clearly

stated in public materials. This yields a SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL rating for Curriculum.

Element 4: Pedagogy or Teaching Methods — SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL

Evidence - The public materials describe a classical approach with a liberal-arts orientation and a traditional curriculum alongside a “whole-group teaching methodology,” which indicates a general classical pedagogy framework. This aligns with some traditional methods but does not provide explicit evidence of Socratic seminars, optimized rhetoric training, or high-school-level seminars. - There is no explicit mention of lower-school singing/chanting, Socratic discussion, or upper-school rhetoric training in the public materials. The absence of these specifics reduces categorical confidence in a fully classical pedagogy. - The school emphasizes formation and virtue in pedagogy rather than only information delivery, but explicit rest-and-contemplation or “scholé” rhythmic practices are not described in public content.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords present: liberal arts, classical, formation, truth/beauty/goodness, education (framing). - Negative keywords present: explicit Socratic-method language, seminars, debates, or public-speaking/rhetoric pedagogy in high school are not described; lower-detail mentions of rest/Scholé are not present.

Why this rating - While the materials reflect a Classical pedagogy frame, the absence of explicit, canonical classical pedagogy practices (e.g., Socratic discussion in upper grades, regular rhetoric training, or a stated sequence of seminars) places Pedagogy at SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL rather than CLASSICAL.

Element 5: Faculty — NOT CLASSICAL

Evidence - Public materials provide standard faculty references (e.g., Headmaster, teachers, and staff) but do not present a “living curriculum” concept or a formal faculty-portrait framework. The explicit language required by the Classical rubric (e.g., “the living curriculum,” “model teachers and mentors,” “portrait of what a teacher should be”) is not evident in the public-facing site content. - Materials highlight a partnership with parents and students and mention specific staff (e.g., Headmaster Brooke Pearson; Alyssa DeLeon as a teacher). However, there is no explicit articulation that teachers themselves embody the curriculum or a formal “teacher portrait” standard.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords present (in the faculty domain): model teachers, living curriculum, portrait of what a teacher should be — none are explicitly present in public content; thus, none of these category-specific positive terms are evidenced. - Negative keywords present: none explicitly. There is simply a lack of explicit language around “living curriculum” or “faculty-as-core.”

Why this rating - The absence of explicit “living curriculum” language, mentor-model faculty language, and a formal teacher-portrait framework in public content provides insufficient evidence to rate Faculty as CLASSICAL. The default here is NOT CLASSICAL given the lack of the required language and framing.

Element 6: Parents & Community — SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL

Evidence - The site emphasizes partnership with families and “working together for the benefit of each child,” which aligns with classical education’s emphasis on parental involvement and community ties. The About content describes a campus where “parents, faculty, and staff can work together for the benefit of each child,” reflecting co-partnership language. - It communicates an ongoing engagement with families through enrollment, news updates, and events (e.g., announcements and events pages), indicating public-facing avenues for parent involvement. - The materials do not explicitly present a formal program of parent education (e.g., book studies, parent gatherings as co-teachers) though there are references to partnership and parent participation.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords present: partnership with parents, co-operation with families, family involvement, events/news for parent engagement, small campus atmosphere (facilitates parent involvement). - Negative keywords present: explicit “parents as co-teachers,” structured parent-education programs, and formal parent-book studies are not described in public text.

Why this rating - The school demonstrates a meaningful, if not fully explicit, partnership stance with parents and community, consistent with SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL classification. The absence of explicit “co-teaching with parents” or formal parent-education programs reduces it from CLASSICAL to SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL.

What Would Move the Needle

- Element 1 (Foundations): Add explicit theology or liturgical/community practices that align with the transcendental, metaphysical aims (e.g., a formal statement of theological grounding or liturgical rhythms) while preserving the public-school status. This would shift Element 1 toward CLASSICAL by strengthening the metaphysical/communal dimension.
- Element 2 (Purpose & Goal): Embed explicit language around formation versus information in policy pages and mission statements, ensuring the “formation” concept is repeatedly foregrounded in all recruitment and curriculum documents.
- Element 3 (Curriculum): Publicly publish a precise Great Books/Great Conversation track, including core canonical works across grades, and articulate how history, literature, philosophy, and sciences are integrated. Include clear references to Trivium/Quadrivium in the curriculum roadmap.
- Element 4 (Pedagogy): Introduce explicit Socratic/seminar-discussion pedagogy for upper grades, with regular seminars, debates, and explicit rhetoric training (speeches and oratory opportunities). Clarify a restful/restorative dimension in lower grades to reflect “scholé” in practice.
- Element 5 (Faculty): Publish a formal “Living Curriculum” concept and a teacher-portrait framework, demonstrating how faculty enact the curriculum, and showcase mentor-models and professional development aligned with classical aims.
- Element 6 (Parents & Community): Implement explicit parent-education programs (e.g., book studies, lectures, teacher-parent collaborative projects) and formal “parents as co-teachers” initiatives, plus explicit openness to parent visits and involvement in classroom activities.

Appendix

ARTIFICIAL INTELLIGENCE DISCLAIMER

This audit was conducted using artificial intelligence tools (including large language models and automated web-analysis scripts) to evaluate the extent to which school websites reflect or incorporate recognized principles of classical education (e.g., the trivium, emphasis on truth/beauty/goodness, integration of great books, Latin/classical languages, Socratic method, rigorous academics, moral/character formation, etc.).

Important Limitations and Caveats

1. **Automated Nature:** The analysis relies on AI interpretation of publicly-accessible school website content as of the date of the audit. It does not involve direct contact with schools, review of internal documents, classroom observation, or verification of curriculum implementation beyond what is stated or implied on the website.
2. **Probabilistic Results:** Scores and assessments are probabilistic and reflect the AI's best interpretation of available text and site structure. They are not infallible and may miss nuance, context, or recent changes not yet reflected online.
3. **Subjectivity of Classical Education:** "Classical Education" encompasses a range of traditions and interpretations (e.g., Dorothy Sayers' trivium model, Classical Christian Education, Great Books programs, etc.). The Humanitas Institute Audit of the Six Elements of Classical Education uses a broad, consensus-based framework derived from prominent classical education organizations and thought leaders. Reasonable people may disagree on weighting or inclusion of specific criteria.
4. **No Official Endorsement or Certification:** Results do not constitute official endorsement, accreditation, or certification by any classical education organization. They are provided for informational and research purposes only.
5. **Potential for Error:** Websites may be incomplete, poorly worded, or temporarily inaccurate. Conversely, sophisticated marketing language may create false positives. Human review by parents, educators, or classical education experts is strongly recommended before drawing final conclusions about any school.
6. **Data Privacy and Ethics:** Only publicly available information was analyzed. No attempts were made to access password-protected areas or collect personal data.
7. **No Liability:** The authors, developers, and distributors of this audit assume no liability for decisions made on the basis of these results. Users are solely responsible for their own due diligence.

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